MOOSE Guidelines for Meta-Analyses and Systematic Reviews of Observational Studies*

	Topic	Page numbe
Title	Identify the study as a meta-analysis (or systematic review)	1:4
Abstract	Use the journal's structured format	2:31
Introduction	**Present:**	
	The clinical problem	3: 60
	The hypothesis	4:127
	A statement of objectives that includes the study population, the condition of interest, the exposure or intervention, and the outcome(s) considered	4:127
Sources	**Describe:**	
	Qualifications of searchers (eg, librarians and investigators)	5:140
	Search strategy, including time period included in the synthesis and keywords	5:140
	Effort to include all available studies, including contact with authors	9:238
	Databases and registries searched	5:141
	Search software used, name and version, including special features used (e.g. explosion)	6:161
	Use of hand searching (e.g, reference lists of obtained articles)	9:246
	List of citations located and those excluded, including justification	N/A
	Method of addressing articles published in languages other than English	9:253
	Method of handling abstracts and unpublished studies	5:142
	Description of any contact with authors	9:238
Study Selection	**Describe**	
	Types of study designs considered	6:152
	Relevance or appropriateness of studies gathered for assessing the hypothesis to be tested	N/A
	Rationale for the selection and coding of data (eg, sound clinical principles or convenience)	N/A
	Documentation of how data were classified and coded (eg, multiple raters, blinding, and inter-rater reliability)	N/A
	Assessment of confounding (e.g. comparability of cases and controls in studies where appropriate)	N/A
	Assessment of study quality, including blinding of quality assessors; stratification or regression on possible predictors of study results	N/A
	Assessment of heterogeneity	N/A
	Statistical methods (eg, complete description of fixed or random effects models, justification of whether the chosen models account for predictors of study results, dose-response models, or cumulative meta-analysis) in sufficient detail to be replicated	N/A
Results	**Present**	
	A graph summarizing individual study estimates and the overall estimate	N/A
	A table giving descriptive information for each included study	N/A
	Results of sensitivity testing (eg, subgroup analysis)	N/A
	Indication of statistical uncertainty of findings	N/A
Discussion	**Discuss**	
	Strengths and weaknesses	N/A
	Potential biases in the review process (eg, publication bias)	9:231

	Assessment of quality of included studies	8:207
	Consideration of alternative explanations for observed results	N/A
	Generalization of the conclusions (ie, appropriate for the data presented and within the domain of the literature review)	N/A
	Guidelines for future research	N/A
	Disclosure of funding source	10:280

*Modified from Stroup DF, Berlin JA, Morton SC, Olkin I, Williamson GD, Rennie D, et al. Meta-analysis of observational studies in epidemiology: a proposal for reporting. Meta-analysis Of Observational Studies in Epidemiology (MOOSE) group. JAMA 2000;283:2008–12. Copyrighted © 2000, American Medical Association. All rights reserved.